



A contemporary oil painting illustrates the 1860 Battle of Guadalajara during the Mexican Reform War between liberals and conservatives.

AFTER MEXICO'S DEFEAT BY THE US (see 1846), many Mexicans were in favor of reform, including the middle-class liberal **Benito Juárez** (1806–72). Installed in the government as justice minister, Juárez and other liberals, including president **Ignacio Comonfort** (1812–63), drafted a new constitution curbing military and ecclesiastical privileges, such as the allocation of special courts for civil trials, and some landholding rights. The constitution, which also prohibited slavery and called for a democracy in Mexico, went into effect in 1857.



RISE OF THE RAJ

With the end of the East India Company's administration in 1857, India was governed directly from London by the Viceroy. This was brought about on November 1, 1858 by governor-general Charles John Canning (1856–62) who became the first Viceroy of India. The period, known as the Raj, lasted until Indian independence in 1947.

However, the Catholic Church and the military refused to accept these reforms, and the antagonism turned into the **War of the Reform** (1857–60). With the conservatives in charge of the military, the liberals found themselves pushed out of Mexico City, and were eventually forced to make a new capital at the port of **Veracruz** in 1858. The US decided to intervene in the conflict, recognizing the liberal government at Veracruz in 1859 and sending it much-needed arms. This aided the rebels in their retaliation, and they managed to defeat conservative forces. Juárez returned to Mexico City on January 1, 1861 as president, taking control of the whole country, and he once again put the constitution into effect.

France, meanwhile, was embroiled in battles not only in China, but in other kingdoms in East and Southeast Asia where the French sought a foothold in trade. France was concerned about the rise of Siamese power, as well as the continuing attacks on French missionaries in Vietnam. By the end of 1858, a Franco-Spanish expedition had seized the city of Da Nang in Vietnam, starting the **Cochinchina Campaign**. In 1859, the coalition captured the key port of **Saigon**, where a garrison of 1,000 troops later faced a year-long siege from 1860 to 1861. The war finally ended in a settlement with Vietnam's king, **Tu Duc** (1829–83), in 1863, in which three provinces were ceded to France.



US Marines under the command of Colonel Robert E. Lee smash the armory door at Harper's Ferry, behind which John Brown and his men were besieged.

“...THE CRIMES OF THIS **GUILTY** LAND WILL NEVER BE PURGED BUT WITH **BLOOD!**”

John Brown, American abolitionist, before his execution, December 2, 1859



EUROPE IN SOUTHEAST ASIA

Throughout the 19th century European powers vied for control of the profitable trade routes from China through Southeast Asia. Goods such as spices were imported to Europe from colonies in Asia, while textiles were exported. The opening of the Suez Canal in 1869 made trade between Europe and Asia quicker and cheaper.

CONSTRUCTION WORK HAD FINALLY BEGUN ON A CANAL that would link the Mediterranean Sea and the Red Sea. It would cut voyages between Europe and Asia by thousands of miles by allowing ships to avoid sailing around the Cape of Good Hope. In 1854, French official **Ferdinand de Lesseps** (1805–94) managed to obtain permission from the khedive (viceroys) of Egypt, Said Pasha (1822–63), to construct a canal at Suez. In 1856, the Suez

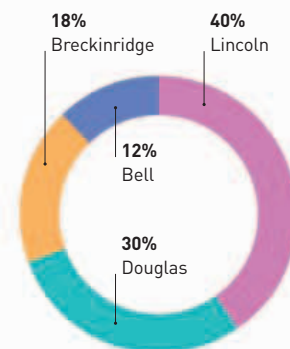
Canal Company (*Compagnie universelle du canal maritime de Suez*) was set up and given the right to run the canal for 99 years after its completion.

In the US, abolitionist **John Brown** (1800–59) attacked a federal armory in **Harper's Ferry, Virginia** on the night of October 16. He also took more than 60 slave owners hostage, hoping that the slaves of these people would join his cause. They were attacked by the local militia

and the rebellion was finally ended by federal troops, led by Colonel Robert E. Lee. Of the 22 men who participated in the raid, 10 were killed, including Brown's two sons. Brown himself was later hanged.

Meanwhile, in England, naturalist **Charles Darwin** (see 1835, 1839) cemented his reputation with the publication of *On the Origin of Species by Means of Natural Selection*. The work explained the process of **evolution** and he set out his ideas about species adaptation and the survival of the fittest.

In the US, Abraham Lincoln (1809–65) won the race for presidency as the candidate for the newly formed **Republican** party, which had been established to curtail the power of existing slave states and stop the creation of new ones. The Democrats had split and fielded two candidates.



A clear majority
The Democratic candidates, Douglas and Breckinridge, combined had more of the popular vote, but Lincoln won the necessary electoral votes.

January 14 Assassination attempt on **Napoleon III** in Paris led by Felice Orsini fails

May–July **Mahtra War**: Peasants in Governorate of Estonia, Russian Empire, revolt against serfdom (already officially abolished)

June 20 Last rebels of the **Sepoy Rebellion** surrender in Gwalior

Wars of Italian Unification (to 1870)

Government of India Act passes control of India from British East India Company to British Crown

1859 American **Edwin Drake** first to drill oil well using piping in the US

1859 French conquer Saigon in Vietnam during Cochinchina Campaign

September 1–2, 1859 Most powerful solar superstorm ever recorded

October 16, 1859 Abolitionist **John Brown** leads an unsuccessful slave rebellion in Virginia, US

c. 1860s Impressionist art movement in Europe

1860 British and French occupy Beijing

April 9, 1860 French typesetter **Edouard-Leon Scott de Martinville** (1817–79) makes world's earliest known sound recording on **phonograph**

1859 Morocco goes to war against Spain (to 1860) over attacks on Spanish enclaves of Ceuta and Melilla

April 25, 1859 Construction of the **Suez Canal** in Egypt begins

1859 Dutch and Portuguese agree to divide the island of **Timor**, in Southeast Asia, and surrounding islands

November 24, 1859 **Charles Darwin** publishes *On the Origin of Species*

1860 Rebels successfully defeat **Qing** forces of 180,000 for a second time at **Nanjing** during **Taiping Rebellion**